

# Malvya Chintakindi

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## CURRENT APPOINTMENT

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Visiting Assistant Professor, **Department of Anthropology, Western Washington University** 2026 – present

## EDUCATION

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PhD Cultural Anthropology, **University of Oregon** 2026  
MA International Policy and Development, **Middlebury Institute of International Studies** 2017  
Concentration: *Monitoring, Evaluation and Design*  
Certificate: *Design, Partnership, Management and Innovation*  
BA Mass Communications (Magna cum laude), **Louisiana State University Shreveport** 2015

## PUBLICATIONS

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### *Peer-Reviewed Publications*

**Chintakindi, M.** (2026). “Dalit Intersectionality as Method and Theory: Women’s Narratives from the Margins of Urban Progress”. In: *Intersectionality beyond Eurocentrism*. Intersectionality in Research Network (InReNet), Tampere University. Forthcoming.

**Chintakindi, M.** (2026). “Dreams Deferred: Navigating Urban Aspiration and Vulnerability among Informal Laborers in Hyderabad”. *Anthropology of Work Review*. revise and resubmit.

**Chintakindi, M.** (2023). “[Informal Labor Blues: Gendered Effects of COVID-19 and Beyond on Women Belonging to Backward Castes in Hyderabad, India](#)”. *Journal of the Indian Anthropological Society*.

**Chintakindi, M.** (2019). “[Gender Transformative Approach to Societal Empowerment](#)”. *Indian Journal of Women and Social Change*.

**Chintakindi, M.** and S. Sood (2019). “Re-examining WASH Outcomes for Behaviour Change and Development: Case of Two Districts in Bihar”. *IASSI Quarterly: Contributions to Indian Social Science*.

### *Other Writing and Public Scholarship*

**Chintakindi, M.** (2025). “[Dreams Deferred: Navigating Aspiration and Constraint in Urban India’s Margins](#)”. *Center for the Study of Women in Society (CSWS) Annual Review*. University of Oregon.

**Chintakindi, M.** (2025). “[Ethnography in Crisis: Fieldwork, Care, and Survival in Tumultuous Times](#)”. *Journal for the Anthropology of North America (JANA)*.

**Chintakindi, M.** (2023). “Informal Labor Blues: Effects of COVID-19 on Dalit Caste Women in Hyderabad”. In: *Interdisciplinary Knowledge Series*. Women’s Studies Unit, Bhairab Ganguly College. New Delhi Publishers.

**Chintakindi, M.** (2022). “Informal Labor Blues: Gendered Effects of COVID-19 and Beyond on Backward Caste Women in India”. *Center for the Study of Women in Society (CSWS) Annual Review*. University of Oregon.

**Chintakindi, M.** and P. Adhikari (2022). “[Let Them Eat Cake: Narratives Around Food Amidst the Pandemic among Backward Communities in India](#)”. *Village Square Journal*.

**Chintakindi, M.** (2019). “[Change through Communities: Lessons from District Bureaucrats](#)”. *Sehgal Foundation Newsletter*.

- Sreedharan, G., D. Datta, N. Jain, and **M. Chintakindi** (2019). “[Nourishing Hard to Reach Communities](#)”. Report. Vihara Innovation Network for Reckitt Benckiser.
- Chintakindi, M.** (2018). “[Positive Deviance and Appreciative Inquiry: The Story of Slowly Transforming Sadai](#)”. *Village Square Journal*.
- Chintakindi, M.** and S. Sood (2018). “[Measuring Happiness and Sustainable Development in India](#)”. *SDG Philanthropy Platform*.
- Sood, S. and **M. Chintakindi** (2018). “[Do Governance and Development Go Hand in Hand?](#)” *New Delhi Times*.
- Mukharya, P., P. Chawla, and **M. Chintakindi** (2017). “[Rapid Assessment of the Phasing Out of Hazardous Pesticides in Dhoraji, Gujarat](#)”. Report. Better Cotton Initiative.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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Graduate Teaching Fellow/Instructor of Record, **University of Oregon** 2020 – 2026

*Courses taught at the University of Oregon*

- ANTH 110 – Introduction to Traditional Ecological Knowledge Fall 2023
- ANTH 114 – Pirates and Piracy Fall 2021, Summer 2024
- ANTH 161 – Introduction to Cultural Anthropology Fall 2022
- ANTH 165 – Sexuality and Culture Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Summer 2023, Fall 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026
- ANTH 220 – Introduction to Nutritional Anthropology Winter 2023, Winter 2025
- ANTH 331 – Cultures of India and South Asia Winter 2022
- ANTH 332 – Human Attraction and Mating Strategies Winter 2024

## FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS & AWARDS

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- Oregon Humanities Center Dissertation Fellowship, University of Oregon (UO) Winter 2026
- Jane Grant Dissertation Fellowship, Center for the Study of Women in Society (CSWS), UO 2025 – 2026
- Sushil Jajodia Indian Student Scholarship, Division of Graduate Engagement, UO 2023 – 2024, 2025 – 2026
- Virginia Green and Leila Johnston Award, Department of Anthropology, UO 2025
- Global Oregon Graduate Research Award, Global Studies Institute, UO 2023, 2025
- Graduate Student Research Grant, CSWS, UO 2021 – 2022, 2024 – 2025
- Asian Studies Graduate Student Presentation Award, Asian Studies Program, UO 2022, 2023
- Center for Asian and Pacific Studies (CAPS) Grant, UO 2023
- Promising Scholar Award, Graduate School, UO 2020
- Peter Grothe Endowed Scholarship for Women, Middlebury Institute of International Studies 2016 – 2017
- Chancellor Award for Academic Achievement, Louisiana State University Shreveport (LSUS) 2015
- Vice-President, Lambda Pi Eta Honor Society; Secretary, Public Relations Student Organization, LSUS 2015
- Kerry Garland Memorial Scholarship, Shreveport Journalism Foundation 2014
- Scholar Awards, LSUS 2013 – 2014
- Top 10 (Novice Division) and Top 25 (Professional Division), International Public Debate Association 2014

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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- “Dreams Deferred: The Paradox of Urban Aspirations,” South Asia Conference of the Pacific Northwest, University of British Columbia (Presenter and Panelist) 2026
- “Pursuing the ‘Good Life’: Narratives of Caste, Class, and Gender in Urban Slums of India,” panel on South Asian Folklore, Western States Folklore Society, University of Oregon (Chair and Panelist) 2026
- “Community-Based Research: Grappling with Ghosts of Research Past, Present, and Future” and “Ghosts: Hauntings, Trauma, and the Anthropological Encounter,” Roundtables, American Anthropological Association Annual Meeting, New Orleans (Panelist) 2025
- “Pursuing the ‘Good Life’: Global Ethnography of Dalit Women’s Aspirations in Urban India’s Informal Economy,” Fourth Global South Graduate Student Conference, George Mason University (Presenter) 2025
- “Navigating Identity and Agency While Rethinking Equity, Sustainability, and Landscapes,” Society for Applied Anthropology Annual Meeting, Portland (Presenter) 2025
- “Praxis as Theory in Colonial Contexts: Anthropological Responsibility and Methodologies of Care,” Roundtable, Society for Applied Anthropology Annual Meeting, Portland (Panelist) 2025
- “The Labor of Caste/the Caste of Labor,” Annual South Asian Studies Conference, University of Wisconsin–Madison (Presenter) 2023
- “Labor and Precarity: Gendered Voices from a New Generation,” South Asia Conference of the Pacific Northwest, University of Washington (Presenter) 2023
- “Ethnography and Qualitative Literacy,” Chicago Ethnography Conference, University of Wisconsin–Madison (Presenter) 2022
- “COVID-19 and Development: Effects and New Realities for the Global South,” WIDER Development Conference, United Nations University (Presenter) 2021
- 19th Annual Conference of the Indian Association of Social Science Institutions (IASSI), NIRD&PR, Hyderabad, India (Presenter) 2019
- “Social Dynamics to Sustainable Futures from Narratives of Vision and Identity,” Institute for Advanced Sustainability Studies (Potsdam) and Risk Society and Policy Research Center, National Taiwan University, Taipei (Presenter) 2018

## INVITED TALKS, GUEST LECTURES & WORKSHOPS

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- Facilitator and Discussant, “Feminist Pedagogies,” Collaboration and Building Bridges: Regional Encounter and Conversation Workshop across the Pacific Northwest 2025
- Invited talk, “In Pursuit of the ‘Good Life’: Gender, Caste and Class in India’s Shadow Economy,” CSWS, UO 2025
- Guest lecture, “The Paradox of Urban Progress in the Global South,” South Asian Folklore (Folklore 410/510), UO 2025
- Guest lecture, “Caste and Anthropology,” Introduction to Cultural Anthropology (ANTH 161), UO 2022
- Invited talk, “How Can I/Do I Decolonize?,” Decolonial Philosophies Collaboratory, UO 2022
- Guest lecture, “Caste, Gender and Labour,” Cultures of South Asia (ANTH 331), UO 2022
- Invited talk, “Informal Labor Blues: Effects of COVID-19 and Beyond on Women Belonging to Backward Castes,” CSWS, UO 2022

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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**Research Associate, [International Initiative for Impact Evaluation \(3ie\)](#)** 2019 – 2020

- Managed two large grant programmes: (1) Swashakt – Empowering Indian Women’s Collectives (USD 7.3 million) and (2) Agricultural Innovation Evidence Program in Africa (USD 1 million)
- Assisted in the day-to-day management of large-scale impact evaluations, including facilitating meetings and communication with project stakeholders in India and Africa
- Contributed to 3ie’s public knowledge base by developing policy-maker friendly briefs, summaries, systematic

reviews, evidence gap maps, blogs, literature reviews, portfolio reviews, learning papers, and data gathering

- Analysed and summarized results from baseline and final reports of impact evaluations on gender empowerment and agricultural innovation
- Participated in key stakeholder meetings and field-based missions, coordinating with donors, thought-partners, grantees, implementers, and policymakers

**Research Manager**, Vihara Innovation Network

2019

- Collected, analysed and interpreted primary and secondary data from low-resource rural and tribal landscapes on maternal and child health vulnerabilities due to climate and environmental factors
- Devised ethnographic research methodologies and utilised appropriate methods and tools
- Managed and delivered research reports and presentations to government and private stakeholders

**Research Associate**, Sehgal Foundation

2018 – 2019

- Conducted research on food security, water security, and social justice
- Collected qualitative data through focus group discussions, key informant interviews, case studies, and observations in rural contexts
- Curated raw datasets, conducted data analysis, and administered statistical tools on datasets
- Led training sessions on qualitative and quantitative tools with the research field team; assisted in formulating and field testing tools

**Research Analyst**, [Outline India](#)

2017 – 2018

- Built research project and field reports and proposals on child education, farming practices, and sexual and reproductive health
- Assisted in drafting, translating, and reviewing qualitative and quantitative survey tools
- Conducted data analysis and performed timely data checks for live projects
- Led field management and field training; supervised data collection and conducted field visits
- Conducted a short-term evaluation of Outline India's research and outcomes

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

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**Languages** English, Telugu, Hindi, Kannada (basic), Tamil (basic)

**Software** MAXQDA, NVivo, SPSS, R, ArcGIS, SurveyCTO, MS Office